PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
School District No. 1J, Multnomah County
Board of Education

February 24, 2026
Work Session with Vote on Consent Agenda

Meeting Minutes

(Adopted 3/10/26)

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In accordance with ORS 192.650, the District's official School Board Meeting Minutes are maintained via video recording and may be viewed at:
https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation

Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Work Session with Vote on Consent Agenda of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center - Board Auditorium, 501 N. Dixon St, Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Present:
Chair Eddie Wang; Vice-Chair Michelle DePass; Directors Rashelle Chase-Miller, Stephanie Engelsman, Virginia LaForte, Christy Splitt, and Patte Sullivan; Student Representative Ian Ritorto; and Superintendent Kimberlee Armstrong

Call to Order and Introductions

The meeting was called to order at 6:01 pm by Board Chair Eddie Wang.

Consent Agenda - Resolutions 7251 through 7256

Time: 6:05 pm

Actions:

- Vice-Chair DePass moved and Director Chase-Miller seconded the motion to adopt Consent Agenda, including Resolutions 7251 and 7256. The motion was put to a voice vote and passed (6 yes – 0 no – 0 abstain)

  Chase-Miller: Yes; DePass: Yes; Engelsman: Absent; La Forte: Yes; Splitt: Yes; Sullivan: Yes; Wang: Yes; Student Representative Ritorto: Yes (unofficial)

Metropolitan Learning Center Programmatic Restructuring

Time: 6:10 pm

Superintendent Armstrong opened by providing some comments about the decision to no longer offer a high school option at the Metropolitan Learning Center. She acknowledged the feedback that has been received on engagement and decision making. She also shared that the legal team has confirmed that the District is operating within Board Policy.

Kristina Howard, Renard Adams, and Isaac Cardona provided a presentation on the restructuring of Metropolitan Learning Center (MLC) to discontinue grades 9-11. Conversations started with principals when looking at providing quality and stable instruction with equity of access for next year and beyond. They shared the enrollment process and enrollment trend at MLC., as well as enrollment demographics, program staffing comparisons, projected savings by the change, and what alternative options are available to students.

Student Representative Ritorto expressed empathy and encouraged people to turn to the State Legislature. Director Sullivan advocated for the state school stability fund to be released and expressed sadness as a former teacher who taught for 20 years at MLC.

Director Chase-Miller stated she understands the need for an alternative school in the District and asked questions about other options for students that benefit from an environment like MLC, for example students who are neuro-divergent. There were questions about engagement, alternative options, process, and the timeline that led up to the decision to no longer offer high school grades. Director La Forte expressed her opinion that she thinks the Policy was not followed and requested a pause and that staff bring forward a fiscal impact statement. Chair Wang acknowledged the decision is hard and that ignoring the issue creates downstream effects.

Public Comment

- Milo Wade-requested that the high school at Metropolitan Learning Center stay open and did not think it was a good process.
- Nicke Peifer-requested that the high school at Metropolitan Learning Center stay open and did not think it was a good process.

- Ezra Weiss-requested that the high school at Metropolitan Learning Center stay open and stated it was a good option for his son.
- Allison Mosher-requested that the high school at Metropolitan Learning Center stay open and did not think it was a good process.
- Crystal Hilton-requested that the high school at Metropolitan Learning Center stay open and stated she thought it was a model program.

Graduation data for SY 2024-2026; Post Secondary Readiness Indicators

Time: 8:03 pm

Kristina Howard, Renard Adams, and Isaac Cardona provided a presentation on Graduation and Completion rates. There was an overview of the graduation data showing there has been a two year trend of lower graduation rates. Staff acknowledged that racial disparities, language barriers, and needing special education services predict lower graduation rates. The District has initiated “Project Graduation” as a short term focus on support for high schools by engaging with principals to understand what targeted support is needed. Staff also walked through the continuum for postsecondary readiness, from transition into high school to advanced credit options.

Board members had questions about the data presented and wondered if there was data that correlated participation in Career Technical Education and graduation rates. There were also questions about the correlation between English Language Learners participating in Dual Language Immersion programs and graduation rates.

Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) Update

Time: 8:47 pm

Russel Adamson provided an update on the Enterprise Resource Planning project which is fully bond funded. This will replace a 25 year old system and will impact all systems across the organization, with the exception of the student information system. He shared a timeline for selection of a vendor. There were questions about the location and makeup of some of the vendors who responded to the request for proposal.

Finance Focus

Time: 8:58 pm

Michelle Morrison shared an update about the current year budget assumption and variances since adoption, including several emergency declarations pertaining to the health and safety at schools that needed to be addressed this year. She shared that the District no longer has the flexibility in its budget to absorb these things as they come up. She provided an overview of mitigation plans in place including spending controls.

Dr. Armstrong shared there is no more fund balance that we can pull to address real needs in schools and that she just learned of this shortfall. This financial hardship is real and any action taken or not taken will have impacts next year.

There were questions about furlough days and what savings it would provide and whether unfunded mandates have contributed to this shortfall. Superintendent Armstrong responded that Oregon Family Leave Act is an example of a requirement that has a big impact on the budget and if furloughs don’t happen, then there will be mid-year layoffs.

Other Business and Future Agenda Items

Time: 9:39 pm

None at this time. Director Splitt thanked the Board and staff for being willing to hear from the Metropolitan Learning Center community.

Adjourn

The meeting was adjourned at 9:42 pm by Board Chair Wang.

Submitted by:

Rosanne Powell
Senior Board Manager
Portland Public Schools

Resolutions As Adopted

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RESOLUTION No. 7251

Adoption of the Minutes

The Following Minutes are offered for Adoption:

- January 27, 2026 – Special Meeting and Work Session
- February 10, 2026 – Regular Meeting

RESOLUTION No. 7252

Expenditure Contracts that Exceed $150,000 for Delegation of Authority

RECITAL

Portland Public Schools ("District") Public Contracting Rules PPS-45-0200 ("Authority to Approve District Contracts; Delegation of Authority to Superintendent") requires the Board of Education ("Board") enter into contracts and approve payment for products, materials, supplies, capital outlay, equipment, and services whenever the total amount exceeds $150,000 per contract, excepting settlement or real property agreements. Contracts meeting this criterion are listed below.

RESOLUTION

The Superintendent recommends that the Board approve these contracts. The Board accepts this recommendation and by this resolution authorizes the Deputy Clerk to enter into the following agreements.

NEW CONTRACTS

No New Contracts

NEW COOPERATIVE PURCHASING AGREEMENTS

No New Cooperative Purchasing Agreements

NEW INTERGOVERNMENTAL AGREEMENTS ("IGAs")

No New Intergovernmental Agreements

AMENDMENTS TO EXISTING CONTRACTS

Contractor	Amendment Term	Contract Type	Description of Services	Amendment Amount; New Contract Amount	Responsible Administrator, Funding Source	Certified Business
Mahlum Architects	2/25/2026 Through 12/31/2029	Architecture ARCH 94069 Amendment 22	Amendment for Phase 2 design work on Cleveland HS Modernization. Request for Proposals 2023-032	$15,149,440 $29,092,728	J. Franco Fund: 461 Dept: 5511	No
AskReply, Inc.	2/25/2026 Through 1/30/2027	Digital Resources DR 85815 Amendment 3	Amendment extends contract and adds funds for continuing use of B2G Certified Business Tracking Software. PPS 47-0288(11) Software and Hardware Maintenance Upgrades	$23,548.30 $152,751.30	J. Franco Fund: 458 Dept: 5511	No

RESOLUTION No. 7253

Revenue Contracts that Exceed $150,000 for Delegation of Authority

RECITAL

Portland Public Schools ("District") Public Contracting Rules PPS-45-0200 ("Authority to Approve District Contracts; Delegation of Authority to Superintendent") requires the Board of Education ("Board") enter into contracts, except as otherwise expressly authorized. Contracts exceeding $150,000 per contractor are listed below.

RESOLUTION

The Superintendent recommends that the Board approve these contracts. The Board accepts this recommendation and by this resolution authorizes the Deputy Clerk to enter into the following agreements.

NEW REVENUE CONTRACTS

No new Revenue Contracts

NEW INTERGOVERNMENTAL AGREEMENTS ("IGAs")

No New Intergovernmental Agreements

AMENDMENTS TO EXISTING CONTRACTS

Contractor	Amendment Term	Contract Type	Description of Services	Amendment Amount; New Contract Amount	Responsible Admin, Funding Source
State of Oregon Department of Education	7/1/2025 Through 9/30/2029	Intergovernmental Agreement / Revenue IGA/R 97036 Amendment 1	Amendment extends date and increases funds for Oregon Comprehensive Literacy State Development Grant.	$4,404,638.80 $5,504,638.80	K. Howard

RESOLUTION No. 7254

Students Requesting Exemption from PE State Requirement

RECITALS

A. In accordance with OAR 581-022-1910, Portland Public Schools may excuse students from a state required program or learning activity, where necessary, to accommodate students' disabilities or religious beliefs:

B. Approval of the exemption shall be based upon and shall include:

1) A written request from the student's parent or guardian or the student, if that student is 18 years of age or older or a legally emancipated minor, listing the reasons for the request and a proposed alternative for an individualized learning activity which substitutes for the period of time exempt from the program and meets the goals of the learning activity or course being exempt;

2) An evaluation of the request and approval by appropriate school personnel (the alternative should be consistent with the student's educational progress and career goals as described in OARs 581-022-1670 and 581-022-1510).

C. Following approval by Portland Public Schools Board of Education, and upon completion of the alternative, credit shall be granted to the student.

RESOLUTION

1. Be it resolved that the Board of Education approves six Portland Public Schools high school students to be granted exemption from the state PE requirement.

2. In accordance with OAR 581-022-1910, all students have a physician statement that documents their specific physical limitation as it relates to this requirement, as well as a written state of agreement from their parent/guardian. All students will replace the PE credit requirement with alternative coursework as required .

RESOLUTION No. 7255

Settlement Agreement

The authority is granted to pay a total of $375,000 to resolve a disputed claim. The settlement agreement will be in a form approved by the Chief Legal Officer.

Resolution No. 7256

Resolution to Appoint Student Representatives to Portland Public Schools Board of Education Committees

RECITALS

A. The Portland Public Schools Board of Education Policy 1.20.014-P Board Committees authorizes Board committees to appoint, subject to Board approval, advisory members from the student body or community in order to obtain internal and external stakeholder input; and to determine the length of term for such advisory members.

B. Policy 1.20.014-P also states that advisory members may not be counted toward quorum requirements and may not vote on recommendations made to the Board.

C. Additionally, 1.20.012-P Student Representative and District Student Council Policy states that the Student Representative shall present opportunities to members of the District Student Council (DSC) to advise Board and District committees and task forces on issues of significance to the DSC and to Portland Public Schools students.

D. The Portland Public Schools Board of Education values student voice and seeks to strengthen student voice and engagement in the work of Board committees by appointing Student Representative members from the District Student Council.

RESOLVED

The Portland Public Schools Board of Education hereby appoints Eve Thompson and Mel Schuller to serve as student advisory members on the Teaching, Learning, and Enrollment Committee, and Nora Isles and Eesa Taylor to serve as student advisory members on the Policy Committee, through June 30, 2026.